

API Design and Service Reliability Guide

CONTROLLED DOCUMENT - SYNTHETIC ENTERPRISE CONTENT FOR RAG TESTING

Document ID	ENG-003	Version	1.0
Owner / Department	Platform Engineering	Effective date	2026-03-05
Access groups	Engineering;Product	Classification	Internal

Purpose and scope

This engineering document establishes a consistent operating standard for Northstar Chain Systems. It applies to personnel in the listed access groups and to approved contractors when they perform work on behalf of the company. Managers are accountable for local adoption; the document owner maintains the standard and annual review cycle.

Service Objectives

Standard. Tier 1 APIs have a monthly availability objective of 99.9 percent. The control exists to make decisions traceable, protect customers and employees, and give teams a predictable operating baseline.

Procedure. Staff should follow the approved workflow, record required approvals in the system of record, and raise exceptions before acting. The accountable owner may provide implementation guidance that is consistent with this standard.

API Contracts

Standard. Payment-creating endpoints must accept an idempotency key and safely replay duplicate requests. The control exists to make decisions traceable, protect customers and employees, and give teams a predictable operating baseline.

Procedure. Staff should follow the approved workflow, record required approvals in the system of record, and raise exceptions before acting. The accountable owner may provide implementation guidance that is consistent with this standard.

Operational Readiness

Standard. A runbook must be published before the service enters production. The control exists to make decisions traceable, protect customers and employees, and give teams a predictable operating baseline.

Procedure. Staff should follow the approved workflow, record required approvals in the system of record, and raise exceptions before acting. The accountable owner may provide implementation guidance that is consistent with this standard.

Roles, exceptions, and evidence

The Platform Engineering team is the policy owner. Questions and requested exceptions must be submitted through the service portal or designated owner channel. Exceptions require documented business rationale, risk assessment where relevant, and an expiry date. Evidence of compliance must be retained in the appropriate company system and provided during an authorized review.

Review and enforcement

This document is reviewed at least annually or sooner when legal, regulatory, operational, or material-risk changes occur. Failure to follow this standard may result in removal of access, corrective action, or escalation under the Company Code of Conduct.